

Camp Trip Swimming Program Safety Certifications for NYS Children's Camps

Fact Sheet – January 2026

(Go to health.ny.gov to view the most current certification list)

When swimming is conducted during a camp trip to an aquatics facility that is supervised by qualified lifeguard(s), the camp must supply one additional lifeguard or a staff member possessing training in Children's Camp Swimming Program Safety for each 75 campers at the swimming activity (see [Aquatic Certifications Fact Sheet](#) for a list of qualified lifeguard certifications). A camp supplied lifeguard or staff trained in swimming safety is not required for aquatic amusement park activities that allow only one or two patrons in the water at a time and the activity water depth does not exceed chest deep for non-swimmers.

The following courses have been accepted by the Department as meeting or exceeding course standards for training in Children's Camp Swimming Program Safety specified in [Section 7-2.11\(a\)\(4\)\(iv\)\(a\)](#) of the State Sanitary Code:

Provider	Certification Title*
American Red Cross (ARC) Lifeguard Management (LGM) certifications: – LGM is only offered online. In-person testing is required and obtained through ARC Lifeguarding Instructors that are ARC Authorized Providers. – Certification expiration date is based on the LGM certificate, not the in-person testing certificate date. Certifications without an expiration date are not valid. Lifeguarding Instructor Trainer or Lifeguarding Instructor r.24 certifications: – Certificates including a combination of Lifeguarding Instructor Trainer r.24 and Lifeguarding Instructor r.24 are acceptable. – Certificates are valid for the time period specified in parentheses after the certification title.	➤ Lifeguard Management – Certifications must be accompanied by a separate certification indicating in-person testing session. ➤ Lifeguarding Instructor r.24 ➤ Lifeguarding Instructor Trainer r.24
American Red Cross on Long Island	➤ Pool Activity Leader
American Aquatics Safety Training	➤ Aquatic Supervisor (Lifeguard Management, Pool Activity Leader)
Scouting America (Boy Scouts of America/BSA)	➤ Aquatics Supervision
YMCA	➤ Lifeguard Supervisor

* Certifications are valid for the time period specified by the certifying agency but may not exceed a consecutive three-year period from course completion.